



PROCESS NAME

DATE RANGE

OBSERVER(S)

SESSIONS

HOW TO USE THIS TEMPLATE

Observe the work happening before filling this out. Document what you see, not what people tell you happens. Each friction point should come from direct observation or validated interview data. Complete one entry per distinct friction point, then summarize on page 2.

Friction Points

FRICTION POINT 1

Name

Location in Process

Description

Frequency

Time Impact

Who is Affected

*Daily / weekly / per transaction**Minutes or hours lost per occurrence*

Current Workaround

Root Cause Hypothesis

Evidence Source

Severity: ☐ High ☐ Med ☐ Low

FRICTION POINT 2

Name

Location in Process

Description

Frequency

Time Impact

Who is Affected

Daily / weekly / per transaction

Minutes or hours lost per occurrence

Current Workaround

Root Cause Hypothesis

Evidence Source

Severity: ☐ High ☐ Med ☐ Low

FRICTION POINT 3

Name

Location in Process

Description

Frequency

Time Impact

Who is Affected

Daily / weekly / per transaction

Minutes or hours lost per occurrence

Current Workaround

Root Cause Hypothesis

Evidence Source

Severity: ☐ High ☐ Med ☐ Low

Friction Summary

Friction Point	Frequency	Impact / Occurrence	Daily Total Impact	Severity

SEVERITY RATING CRITERIA

- High** More than 30 minutes/day total impact across all occurrences.
- Medium** 10 to 30 minutes/day total impact.
- Low** Less than 10 minutes/day total impact.

Patterns Observed

What themes or connections do you see across friction points?

Recommended Priority

Rank the friction points that should be addressed first. Consider total impact, feasibility, and alignment with project objectives.

- 1

Highest Priority

Which friction point and why?

2

Second Priority

Which friction point and why?

3

Third Priority

Which friction point and why?

COMMON PITFALLS

Documenting symptoms instead of root causes. Relying only on what managers say happens instead of observing directly. Skipping the time-impact quantification (this is what turns observations into business cases). Confusing minor inconveniences with genuine friction that blocks work.